



AHTESHAM ZULFI

House No. 428, Block D, Punjab University Employees Housing Society Town II, Lahore, Pakistan.
Phone: +92 300 4098982

D.O.B: 01-July-1981

Marital Status: **Married**

E-Mail: ahteshamzulfi@gmail.com

Motivated performer with highly visible middle-management accountabilities, eager to be exposed to diversified spheres of Profession, where in I get opportunity to widen my horizons and contribute towards the healthy pursuit of excellence for the organization I serve.

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

- Performance-driven finance professional with approximately **19 + years** of continuous advancement and expertise in Corporate Accounting, Financial & Management Reporting, Internal & External Audits, Inventory Management, All Sales, Income and Hotel related Tax matters and Corporate Affairs and complete **Hotel Management**.
- Have complete knowledge of IFRS, Accounting, Auditing standards and Companies Ordinance 1984;
- Proven ability to work independently as well as perform as a team member.
- Exercised degree of discretion and tact in handling issues of sensitive nature.
- Proactive self-starter with track record of initiative, personal responsibility, ownership of work and reputation for removing obstacles and making things happen.
- Analytical thinker with demonstrated ability to scrutinize technical and financial data.
- Strong leader with motivational style who effectively directs top-level strategic corporate initiatives.
- Superlative interpersonal communicator, presenter, and negotiator; delivered effective presentations to executives.
- Creative, dependable and enthusiastic change agent with proven track record in improving efficiencies.
- Excellent verbal and writing skills with a command on three languages.

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| • Hotel Management | • Cash Flow Analysis & Management |
| • Financial Management | • Corporate Reporting & Analysis |
| • Budget Development & Planning | • Corporate & Tax Affairs |
| • Inventory Management | • Financial Accounting |
| • Policies & Procedures Development | • ERP Implementation |
| • Management Consultancy | • Internal & External Audits |

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

➤ **DIRECTOR OF FINANCE (RAMADA BY WYNDHAM)** (From 08-01-2020 to Date)



Currently Working as a **Director of Finance** in **Ramada by Wyndham** (an international chain of FIVE STAR Hotels) having 140 Room keys. Whereby, I am heading accounts and finance matters with below responsibilities;

- Responsible for the properties overall accounting and financial management requirements.
- Responsible to represent the finance department during daily morning HOD's meetings.
- Advises the GM and executive committee on existing and evolving operating/financial issues.
- Responsible for the local tax authority compliance of the hotel.
- Responsible to support and liaise with the General Manager in meeting the strategic goals of the organisation.
- Responsible for preparing and reviewing annual budgets, monthly forecasts, operating results.
- Analyses information, forecasts sales against expenses and creates annual budget plans.
- Compiles information, analyses and monitors actual sales against projected sales.
- Responsible for verifying all financial reports and ensuring that all transactions are accurate and in compliance with local government regulations.
- Responsible to liaise with the hotel owner/CEO or managing director of the organisation.
- Able to prepare and submits management reports in a timely manner and also ensuring delivery deadlines.
- Able to effectively implement all accounting policies and procedures.
- Able to ensure a strong accounting and operational control environment to safeguard hotel assets.
- Able to assists proactively with cost control requirements.

- Able to assist with revenue enhancement possibilities.
- Able to assist with profit improvement opportunities for the hotel operations.
- Able to develop specific goals and plans to prioritise, organise and accomplish the work.
- Assists in the building of an efficient and professional team of employees within Finance and Accounting Department.
- Monitors all local tax compliance that applies, and ensuring that taxes are charged correctly and collected.
- File the local tax with the concerned authority on a monthly/regular basis.
- Monitor and improve hotels operation costs, profitability and manage business risks.
- Ensures profits and losses are documented accurately.
- Ensures property policies are administered fairly and consistently.
- Achieves and exceeds goals including performance goals, budget goals, team goals, etc.
- Oversees internal, external and regulatory audit processes.
- Conduct regular weekly finance department meetings.
- Celebrates successes by publicly recognising the contributions of team members.
- Provides excellent leadership by differentiates top performers, fosters teamwork and also able to encourages work/life balance.
- Establishes and maintains open, collaborative relationships with employees.
- Ensures employees establish and maintain open, collaborative relationships within their team.
- Participates in the employee performance appraisal process, providing feedback as needed.
- Responsible to ensure disciplinary procedures and documentation are completed according to hotels standard.
- Any other tasks as and when required by the management.

➤ **ASSISTANT DIRECTOR FINANCE (HOTEL ONE)**

(From 04-05-2019 to 08-01-2020)



Worked as an **Assistant Director Finance** in **Hotel One (Pvt) Limited** (a chain of FIVE STAR Pearl Continental Hotels - Hashoo Group). Whereby, I continued to take on all accounts and finance matters of the 20 Hotels in all over the country divided in different regions more the 500+ Rooms keys with some additional responsibilities.

- Responsible for the properties overall accounting and financial management requirements.
- Responsible to represent the finance department during daily morning HOD's meetings.
- Managing cash flow management.
- Responsible to support and liaise with the Director Finance, General Manager in meeting the strategic goals of the organisation.
- Part of the Pre-Opening Team of Hotel.
- Responsible for preparing and reviewing annual budgets, monthly forecasts, operating results.
- Responsible for verifying all financial reports and ensuring that all transactions are accurate and in compliance with IFRS and local government regulations.
- Responsible and submits management reports in a timely manner and also ensuring delivery deadlines.
- Effectively implemented all accounting policies and procedures.
- Ensuring a strong accounting and operational control environment to safeguard hotel assets.
- Assists proactively with cost control requirements.
- Assists with revenue enhancement possibilities.
- Assists with profit improvement opportunities for the hotel operations.
- Developed specific goals and plans to prioritise, organise and accomplish the work.
- Assists in the building of an efficient and professional team of employees within Finance and Accounting Department.
- Responsible for the local tax authority compliance of the hotel.
- Monitors all local tax compliance that applies and ensuring that taxes are charged correctly and collected.
- File the local tax with the concerned authority on a monthly/regular basis.
- Monitor and improve hotels operation costs, profitability and manage business risks.
- Ensures profits and losses are documented accurately.
- Ensures property policies are administered fairly and consistently.
- Achieves and exceeds goals including performance goals, budget goals, team goals, etc.
- Oversees internal, external and regulatory audit processes.
- Conduct regular weekly finance department meetings.
- Celebrates successes by publicly recognising the contributions of team members.
- Provides excellent leadership by differentiates top performers, fosters teamwork and also able to encourages work/life balance.
- Establishes and maintains open, collaborative relationships with employees.
- Ensures employees establish and maintain open, collaborative relationships within their team.
- Observes the employee performance appraisal process, providing feedback as needed.

- Responsible to ensure disciplinary procedures and documentation are completed according to hotels standard.
- Any other tasks as and when required by the management.

➤ **CORPORATE MANAGER ACCOUNTS & FINANCE** (From 23-11-2017 to 03-05-2019)



Worked as a **Corporate Manager Accounts & Finance** in **Hotel One (Pvt) Limited** (a chain of FIVE STAR Pearl Continental Hotels - Hashoo Group). Whereby, I was taking care of all accounts and finance matters of the 16 Hotels with more the 500+ Rooms keys, which is also growing in future years. My key responsibilities are as follows;

➤ **MANAGER ACCOUNTS & FINANCE** (From 17-10-2011 to 22-11-2017)



Worked as a **Property Manager Accounts & Finance** in **Hotel One (Pvt) Limited** a chain of FIVE STAR Pearl Continental Hotels (Hashoo Group). Whereby, I was responsible for all accounts and finance matters of 16 Hotels extending with 500+ Rooms keys.

➤ **MANAGER AUDIT & ASSURANCE** (From 06-06-2008 to 16-10-2011)



Worked in capacity of **Manager Audit and Assurance** in **Nasir Javaid Maqsood Imran, Chartered Accountants, Lahore** where managed and supervised all internal and external audits and management consultancy assignments of various clients.

International Exposure (KSA & Bahrain)

- I had participated in an international assignment based in **Saudi Arabia** of a **Company named as Saudi Material Recycling Company (SAMARCO)** engaged in purchase and sales of obsolete and scrap material, wherein, I lead, planned and performed finance department system developments, Time and Motion Study and also reviewed the Internal Controls procedures of the Company.
- Also participated in an assignment based in **Saudi Arabia and Bahrain** of a Company named as **National Air Services (NAS Air)** which has Airline network all over Middle East where I planned and performed Internal audit of Company's Payroll and internal control systems.

➤ **ARTICLES (ICAP)** (From 01-01-2003 to 05-06-2008)



Completed **Five (05)** years of Practical Training under Bye Laws of the **Institute of Chartered Accountants of Pakistan (ICAP)** with **Nasir Javaid Maqsood Imran Ashfaq, Chartered Accountants, Lahore.**

During the period of training, I supervised audits of the following Industries as Internal and External Auditor.

- | | |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| • Fuel & Power Sector | • Banks |
| • Textile Sector | • Communication Sector |
| • Financial Institutions | • Print & Electronic Sector |
| • Brokerage House | • Investment Advisor Companies |
| • Software Development Houses | • Real Estate & Construction Sector |
| • NGO's | • Pesticide Companies |

Scope of Above Audits: -

- Preparation of work plans, allocation of audit area and Supervising audit work of assistants. Study of accounting systems and internal control procedures in operation.
- Review of company's tax position and pending tax assessments.
- Verification of final accounts of Companies in accordance with International Accounting Standards, International Standards of Auditing and Companies Ordinance, 1984.
- Report to client's management for weaknesses in their system including recommendations thereon.
- Filing of Monthly and annually **Sales Tax Returns**.
- Worked on **Sales Tax Refunds** of various clients electronically and manually.
- Filing of Monthly and annually **Income Tax Statements**.
- Filing of annual **Income Tax Returns** for corporate and AOP's etc.
- Filing of Corporate Forms and annual returns.
- Having full practical knowledge of incorporation of companies.

- Having full grip of all SECP matters.
- Having working experience of **Winding of Companies** with normal as well as CEES Scheme.
- Implementations of ERP systems.
- Workers' Profit Participation Fund (WPPF) – Maintained Books & Audit
- Provident Fund - Maintained Books & Audit
- Gratuity Fund - Maintained Books & Audit
- Sales Tax Audit - Maintained Books & Audit
- Income Tax Audit
- System Audit of Brokerage House
- Fixed Assets maintenance & Verifications

EDUCATION

- **CIA** – *Member of Institute of Certified Internal Auditors of Pakistan (2021)*
- **CGA** – *Member of Institute of Certified General Accountants of Pakistan (2018)*
- **ACCA (Finalist)** – *Association of Chartered Certified Accountants, Glasgow, UK (2022)*
- **Bachelor of Commerce** – *University of the Punjab, Pakistan (2001)*
- **Intermediate of Commerce** – *B.I.S.E Lahore, Pakistan (1999)*
- **Matriculation** – *B.I.S.E Lahore, Pakistan (1997)*

SKILLS - TECHNICAL & COMPUTER

- Experience of working in “**Oprah**”.
- Experience of working in “**Oracle Financials**”.
- Experience of working in “**Munshi 10**”.
- Experience of working in “**SBT**” (**Software Business Techniques**)
- Experience of working in “**Quick Books**”.
- Experience of working in “**Peachtree**”.
- MS OFFICE (Excel, Word, Power Point, Access).

WORKSHOPS AND TRAININGS

- **Management Training**
Participated in a Training session “**Simply A Great Manager**” held by Hotel One (Hashoo Group) in which continuous development of managers were highlighted.
- **International Financial Reporting Standards**
Attended a series of workshops held by Institute of Chartered Accountants of Pakistan (ICAP) about the developments in International Accounting and Financial Reporting Standards.
- **Tax System Up gradation**
Attended workshops arranged by Federal Board of Revenue (FBR) about introduction and up gradations in new Tax system in all over the Pakistan.
- **Powerful Interactions**
Held by ACCA Pakistan about the interactions with people presented by a renowned presenter from big companies.
- **Diploma in Microsoft Office**
Having strong and professional grip on Microsoft Office and Achieved Diploma in Microsoft Office.
- **National Cadet Corps Training**
Enthusiastically participated in 3 months Training of National Cadet Corps arranged by Pakistan Army.

Co-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

- Enjoy reading books.
- Actively explore Internet to enhance my knowledge.
- Watch and Like to play Cricket a more but with other games too.

REFERENCES

Mr. Nasir Gulzar, FCA

Partner

Nasir Javaid Maqsood Imran Ashfaq , Chartered Accountants

Mobile: +92-321-4401947

E-Mail: nasirgulzar@njmi.net

Mr. Muhammad Maqsood, FCA

Partner

Nasir Javaid Maqsood Imran Ashfaq , Chartered Accountants

Mobile: +92-321-4401946

E-Mail: maqsood170L@hotmail.com